

SFTP FAQ

Frequently Asked Questions

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Quick answers about the enterprise SFTP management system. Deeper coverage: [guides](#) · [tutorials](#) · [architecture](#). Answers referencing not-yet-built components cite their ATM item.

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1. What is this project?

An enterprise-grade SFTP management system: an `atmoz/sftp` server in rootless Podman, wrapped by a Go REST API (port 7722), a React web admin console, and KMP mobile clients (Android/iOS/HarmonyOS/AuroraOS). It manages accounts, permissions, audit logging, backups, and config — so you never hand-edit `users.conf` again.

2. What do I need to install it?

A Linux host with Podman ≥ 3.4 (host reference 5.7.1) and podman-compose (pip3 install --user podman-compose), plus an sftp client for testing. No Docker daemon, no Kubernetes. Full steps: [deployment guide](#) or the 10-minute [quickstart](#).

3. Do I need root or sudo?

No. The entire stack runs in **rootless Podman** under an unprivileged user, with systemctl --user units (§11.4.161). The only optional host-admin touchpoints are opening a firewall port and loginctl enable-linger (survive logout) — see [troubleshooting](#) §7–§8.

4. Which ports does it use?

- **7721/tcp** — SFTP (maps to container sshd port 22; configurable via SFTP_PORT).
- **7722/tcp** — REST API (configurable via API_PORT; bind to loopback or put behind TLS — see [security guide](#) §8).

5. How do I create the first administrator?

Run bash scripts/setup.sh (ATM-006): it prompts for the super-admin username/password (never echoed, §11.4.10) and calls the single-shot bootstrap endpoint. A second bootstrap attempt returns 409 — by design.

6. How do I add an SFTP user?

Three ways, all equivalent: REST API (POST /api/v1/accounts), web console (Accounts → New), mobile app (Accounts → +). See [user management guide](#) and [API quickstart](#). Direct users.conf edits are not supported — the API re-renders that file from the DB.

7. What do read_only and read_write mean?

read_only — list and download only; uploads/renames/deletes are rejected (verified by a live container round-trip in ATM-003).

read_write — full access inside the user's own home subtree.

These are the only two permission values; the model is detailed in [permissions_model.md](#).

8. Can a user be public / anonymous?

Only deliberately. public defaults to false everywhere; enabling it requires an explicit acknowledgement in the request/console, forces read_only, and is audit-logged. It is never on by default (operator mandate, ATM-002).

9. Why can't a user write into their home directory top level?

Because OpenSSH chroot requires the chroot directory to be root-owned and non-user-writable — this is what makes the confinement trustworthy. Each user gets a writable subdirectory (e.g. upload/) for their files; the provisioner creates it automatically. Details: [troubleshooting §4](#).

10. Where is user data stored, and how do I back it up?

All user homes live under the host data directory (./data by default, SFTP_DATA_DIR), mapped into the container. bash scripts/backup.sh (ATM-006) snapshots the DB + data + users.conf; backup.sh restore <id> restores. Delete-account retains data unless purge_data=true.

11. Are passwords stored in plaintext?

No. The API DB stores Argon2id hashes, and users.conf carries crypt hashes with the :e marker that atmoz/sftp supports. Plaintext never appears in logs, audit entries, or API responses (§11.4.10).

12. Can I use SSH keys instead of passwords?

Yes — recommended for production. Attach a public key to an account (POST /api/v1/accounts/<user>/keys, ATM-002); the container appends it to `authorized_keys` via the `.ssh/keys/` mount. A key-only account has an empty password field. Global `PasswordAuthentication no` is the production end-state.

13. Is there a web interface? A mobile app?

- **Web:** React/TypeScript SPA with OpenDesign light/dark themes (ATM-004).
- **Mobile:** KMP + Compose Multiplatform clients for Android, iOS, HarmonyOS, AuroraOS (ATM-005).

Both consume the same REST API and enforce the same guards (e.g. the public-flag acknowledgement).

14. Is Firebase required?

No — it is opt-in (ATM-007). Analytics/Performance/Crashlytics initialize only behind env flags, and App Distribution is used for mobile builds. Config files are fetched by `scripts/firebase_config.sh` into git-ignored paths; no Firebase credentials are ever committed.

15. What languages is the UI available in?

English first (en), via the i18n client stack on web and the in-project KMP i18n on mobile (ATM-004/005). The architecture keeps localization data-driven so additional languages drop in without code changes.

16. How do I upgrade safely?

Fetch + `ff-merge`, snapshot with `backup.sh`, pull new images, restart, and re-run the verification steps — migrations apply automatically on API start. Rollback = restore snapshot + pin previous image. Full procedure: [deployment guide §7–§8](#).

17. How do I get support / report a bug?

Open an issue on the project repository. For deployment problems, first run the [troubleshooting guide](#) playbooks and include podman logs output and the failing verification step in your report.

Sources verified (2026-07-11)

- Internal: docs/Issues.md ATM-001..ATM-011 · docs/research/mvp/MVP.md · docs/CONTINUATION.md · sibling docs in docs/guides/, docs/tutorials/, docs/architecture/.
- External fetched this revision: <https://github.com/atmoz/sftp> · <https://github.com/containers/podman-compose> · <https://docs.podman.io/en/latest/> (facts as cited in the guides).